

CHESSTUTOR | BASIC RULES AND TERMS

1. Stages of the Game: Definition and Character

OPENING	MIDDLEGAME	ENDGAME
Definition: The kings are not yet permanently safe. Usually, the pieces have not yet been developed. Character: The aim is to bring your own army into play quickly and prepare for the middlegame.	Definition: The kings are safe, but they must be well defended. Character: Many pieces. Counterplay cannot be prevented. Because there are so many possibilities, you must be careful here and pay particular attention to tactical possibilities.	Definition: The kings can move safely around the board. Character: Play is slower and there is more time. Small weaknesses now decide the game. The king plays an active role. The aim is to win pawns or promote them.

2. Guiding Rules for the Three Stages of the Game

OPENING • Check active moves first. Tactical possibilities take precedence over general rules. • GOLDEN RULES: 1. Center 2. Development 3. King safety. • Hierarchy: Center > Development > King safety. • After choosing the move, before playing it: check the opponent's active replies. <i>*If an opening line has been memorized completely from a reliable source, it can be played quickly without paying attention to the points above.</i> <i>**Tactics occur less often in the opening, but they must not be forgotten entirely.</i>	MIDDLEGAME • 1. Check active moves. If a convincing continuation is found, play it. (→ More on calculation technique in Part 30+) • 2. Follow the plan: The plan arises from understanding the position, intuition, or a typical plan from the specific opening. (→ The more positional rules you know, the more precise the plan will be at this point. More on this in Part 10.) 2b. If there is no plan: improve the placement of the pieces. Try to find a plan thereafter. • 3. Check the opponent's reply. Before playing the move, check the opponent's active replies to it. If there is a problem: return to step 2 and find an alternative. <i>**To put it more precisely: the middlegame is very complex, whereas the opening and endgame can formulate point 2, the "plan," quite concretely.</i>	ENDGAME (• Do not forget active moves) • Winning Strategies: - Win pawns. - Create passed pawns and try to promote them. - Generally useful: Activate the king. To activate = to give a task. (→ This is explained in greater detail in Part 20.) (• Do not forget the opponent's active moves) <i>**Tactics occur less often in the endgame, but they must not be forgotten entirely.</i>
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3. Important Strategic Terms

COUNTERPLAY It is almost always better to become active yourself instead of defending passively: create threats, counterattack, and confront the opponent with problems of their own.	STATIC ADVANTAGE A lasting advantage. It remains even without immediate action and can be converted calmly and step by step.
DYNAMIC POSITION / DYNAMIC ADVANTAGE The advantage is temporary. Actively calculate concrete variations and, if possible, convert it into something lasting.	TRANSFORMATION OF THE POSITION When the character of the position changes, reassess the situation, adapt the previous plan, or find a new plan.
MATERIAL ADVANTAGE When you have a material advantage, generally trade down into an endgame.	MATERIAL DISADVANTAGE When you are behind in material, generally seek counterplay and exchange pawns.